THE NEXT 100

POLITICS

SAFFRON STAR

TEJASVI SURYA, 31

Lok Sabha MP, BJP, Bengaluru



There cannot be a more complete package for BJP than Tejasvi Surya. An RSS swayamsevak, ABVP member and Yuva Morcha leader, law graduate, digitally literate and committed to party ideology. Eyeing this very potential, BJP chose the then 28-year-old over Tejaswini, wife of Ananth Kumar, a six-time BJP MP and the party's most prominent face in Delhi, after his death in November 2018 to represent Bangalore South in the 2019 general election. Surya won, trouncing veteran Congress leader B.K. Hariprasad by 331,000 votes to become the youngest BJP MP in the 17th Lok Sabha.

Like other gen-next politicians, Tejasvi, too, is internet and social media savvy, with million-plus followers on Twitter. He is also approachable; don't be surprised if you see him at a coffee shop chatting with his electorate. He remains faithful to the saffron agenda, whether it's asking for an NRC in Karnataka, or calling for BJP to be unapologetically a party of Hindus, or accusing those who oppose Narendra Modi of strengthening 'anti-India forces'. As a lawyer, he has represented those whom BJP thought the Congress government in Karnataka had targeted. Education is another cause close to his heart; he runs an NGO called Arise India, which works in the field of school education. During the pandemic, he set up a special Covid task force for his constituency for medical aid and doorstep delivery of essential goods. You know who BJP's preferred candidate for the 2024 general election will be. n

– Amarnath K. Menon

ARTISTICALLY INCLINED He was nine when he sold his paintings to contribute to the Kargil fund. He is also a trained Carnatic musician and an avid biker

"Tejasvi Surya was destined to become a national leader since his school days. He is a force that cannot be stopped, as he is always raring to go"

A.H. ANAND, *Spokesperson, Karnataka BJP*

Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH